DESIGN CAPSULE · INDIA 2026–28

Design Capsule: Indigo, blue and white

Indigo denim, blue-and-white prints and tailoring were the most-seen colour story on the Indian runway.

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Mood and colour



Pantone TCX (cotton) codes are the nearest match to the screen colour; confirm against a physical Pantone book and lab dips before production.

Why? Blue is easy to wear across age groups and works for both festive and everyday. Indigo also links to India's dyeing heritage, so it suits handloom and denim alike.

What? Blue ran through Lakmé Fashion Week 2026: indigo denim and crisp tailoring, blue-and-white evening gowns with fine surface work, and whole shows built on indigo.

Who's showing it?

- **Payal Pratap**: Indigo denim and structured tailoring
- **AFEW by Rahul Mishra**: Blue-and-white eveningwear with surface work
- **Saim**: Silk Chanderi paired with denim

Key pieces

The key pieces with reference photos, ready to brief into design.



Indigo denim with handloom

RISING

Indigo denim teamed with handloom pieces.

- Festive 26 Rising
- Summer 27 Rising
- Festive 27 Peaking
- Summer 28 Peaking
- Festive 28 Fading



Chanderi with denim

EMERGING

Silk Chanderi paired with denim, as shown by Saim.

- Festive 26 Emerging
- Summer 27 Rising
- Festive 27 Rising
- Summer 28 Peaking
- Festive 28 Peaking



Embroidered denim jackets

EMERGING

Denim jackets with Indian embroidery.

- Festive 26 Emerging
- Summer 27 Rising
- Festive 27 Peaking
- Summer 28 Peaking
- Festive 28 Fading



Ikat

RISING

Resist-dyed yarns woven into blurred patterns.

Festive 26 Rising	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking	Summer 28 Peaking
Festive 28 Fading			



Block print

PEAKING

Hand block prints from Bagru and Sanganer.

Festive 26 Peaking	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking	Summer 28 Peaking
Festive 28 Peaking			



Kurtas with jeans and sneakers

PEAKING

The everyday Gen Z mix of kurta, denim and sneakers.

Festive 26 Peaking	Summer 27 Peaking	Festive 27 Peaking	Summer 28 Peaking
Festive 28 Peaking			

Price guide (India)

KEY GARMENT	VALUE	MID	PREMIUM
Indigo kurta or shirt	₹799–1,499	₹2,000–4,500	₹8,000+
Denim co-ord or jacket	₹1,499–2,999	₹3,500–7,000	₹12,000+
Blue-white printed saree	₹1,299–2,499	₹3,000–7,500	₹15,000+

Cost to make: Low. Indigo dyeing and prints are widely available. Use natural indigo for premium and synthetic indigo for value.

How to build the capsule

- Add indigo to every category: kurtas, denim, sarees and footwear.
- Pair indigo with ivory and champagne gold for festive.
- Try one denim-meets-handloom fusion piece.

Range plan

Build around indigo in several depths with white and ecru. Mix prints and solids: block prints, stripes and plain cotton, so customers can combine pieces.

- **Hero pieces (about 20%):** the strongest expression of the story, at higher prices.
- **Core pieces (about 60%):** easy-to-wear styles in the capsule colours.
- **Add-ons (about 20%):** accessories and layers that increase basket size.

Selling it in different regions

In India, time the capsule to the festive or summer window it suits. For South Asian communities abroad, link it to local festival dates and weddings. For international customers new to Indian fashion, lead with easy pieces such as shirts, jackets and scarves, and explain the craft.

Common questions

Does indigo bleed? Natural and synthetic indigo can transfer colour; wash before first wear and test rub fastness before bulk.

Is blue and white a summer-only story? It leads in summer, but deep indigo works across seasons.

Sources: Harper's Bazaar India and Free Press Journal, Lakmé Fashion Week 2026.